CHAPTER 1

Development

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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Answers to questions are self-explanatory and written in a simple way.
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Activity · Table 1.1 Developmental Goals of Different Categories of Persons

1 **Complete Table 1.1: what development or progress means to different persons (their aspirations).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model table (your own ideas may differ):

Category of person	Developmental goals / aspirations
Landless rural labourers	More days of work and better wages; good local school for children; no social discrimination; chance to become village leaders
Prosperous farmers from Punjab	High family income through higher support prices and cheap labour; settle children abroad
Farmers who depend only on rain	Irrigation facilities (canals, check dams, tubewells), timely rain, cheap loans, crop insurance and fair prices
A rural woman from a land owning family	Equal say in decisions, ownership rights in land, education, health care, freedom and respect, safety
Urban unemployed youth	A regular job with good salary, skill training, job security
A boy from a rich urban family	Good higher education (maybe abroad), a well-paid career or own business, a comfortable lifestyle

A girl from a rich urban family	As much freedom as her brother; decide what to do in life; study abroad
An adivasi from Narmada valley	Not to be displaced from land and forest; proper rehabilitation if displaced; protection of their culture and livelihood; small check dams instead of big dams

⭐ Let's Work These Out · What Development Promises

1 **Why do different persons have different notions of development? Which of the following explanations is more important and why?**

(a) Because people are different.

(b) Because life situations of persons are different.

✔ ANSWER

Different persons have different needs, desires and life situations, so they have different notions of development.

(b) is more important. A person's goals depend on his or her life situation – income, place of living, job, gender, social group.

- A landless labourer wants more days of work and better wages.
- A prosperous farmer wants higher support prices for crops.

So people seek what is most important for them in their own situation.

2 **Do the following two statements mean the same? Justify your answer.**

(a) People have different developmental goals.

(b) People have conflicting developmental goals.

✔ ANSWER

No, they do not mean the same.

- **Different goals:** people want different things, but one person's goal does not harm another (e.g. a labourer wants better wages, a student wants a good school).
- **Conflicting goals:** what is development for one may be harmful for another. E.g. industrialists want more dams for electricity, but dams submerge land and displace tribals.

So different goals can exist together; conflicting goals clash with each other.

3 **Give some examples where factors other than income are important aspects of our lives.**

✔ ANSWER

- Equal treatment, freedom, security and respect from others.

- Friendship and a happy family life.
- A safe and pollution-free environment.
- Good health, education and job security.
- Choosing a job for working atmosphere, facilities for family or chance to learn, not only for pay.

4 **Explain some of the important ideas of the above section in your own words.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Different people have different developmental goals because their life situations differ.
- What is development for one may not be development for another; it may even be destructive for the other (e.g. big dams and displaced tribals).
- People want more income: regular work, better wages and fair prices.
- Besides income, people also want equal treatment, freedom, security and respect.
- Non-material things are not easy to measure, but they are very important for the quality of life.

💬 Discuss · National Development

? **Discuss among yourselves on what India should do for development.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model points:

- Create more jobs and raise incomes of the poor.
- Give good, free school education and health care to all.
- Reduce inequality between rich and poor, men and women, and regions.
- Improve infrastructure: roads, electricity, clean drinking water, sanitation.
- Protect the environment and use resources in a sustainable way.
- Ensure safety, equal rights and respect for all citizens.

⭐ Let's Work These Out · National Development

1 **Look at the picture on the right (a tall building next to slums). What should be the developmental goals for such an area?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The picture shows tall, modern buildings with slums next to them, i.e. great inequality.

- Proper, affordable housing for slum dwellers.

- Clean drinking water, toilets, drainage and electricity for all.
- Regular jobs and better wages for the poor.
- Government schools and health centres nearby.
- A clean environment and reduced gap between rich and poor.

2 (i) **A vessel dumped 500 tonnes of liquid toxic wastes into open-air dumps in Abidjan, Ivory Coast (Africa). Seven persons died, twenty were in hospital and 26,000 were treated for poisoning. A multinational company had contracted a local company to dispose the waste.**

Who are the people who benefited and who did not?

✔ ANSWER

- **Benefited:** the multinational company (got rid of its toxic waste cheaply) and the local company (got money for the contract).
- **Did not benefit:** the people of Abidjan and nearby areas – some died, many fell ill; the environment (land and sea) was polluted.

2 (ii) **What should be the developmental goal for this country?**

✔ ANSWER

- A clean and safe environment for its people.

- Strict laws to stop dumping of toxic waste and punish those who do it.
- Good health facilities for the affected people.
- Development that protects people's health, not only one that earns money.

3 **What can be some of the developmental goals for your village, town or locality?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Good roads, regular electricity and clean drinking water.
- Good schools and a health centre nearby.
- More jobs and fair wages.
- Proper drainage, sanitation and garbage disposal.
- Safety for women and children; parks and playgrounds.

🧪 Activity 1

? **If you know of any controversy about ways of developing, try to find out arguments advanced by different people (by talking to people, or from newspapers and television).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Example: raising the height of the Sardar Sarovar Dam on the Narmada.

- **For:** more irrigation water, drinking water for dry areas of Gujarat and Rajasthan, more electricity.
- **Against (Narmada Bachao Andolan, adivasis):** thousands of people lose land and homes, forests are submerged, rehabilitation is poor.
- **Middle view:** build smaller dams/check dams, and give full and fair rehabilitation before raising the height.

Other examples: a new highway or airport, a factory or mine near a village, cutting trees for a metro line.

⭐ Average Income · Table 1.2 Comparison of Two Countries

1 **Calculate the average income for both the countries.**

Country	I	II	III	IV	V
Country A	9500	10500	9800	10000	10200
Country B	500	500	500	500	48000

✔ ANSWER

- Country A: (9500 + 10500 + 9800 + 10000 + 10200) ÷ 5 = 50000 ÷ 5 = **Rs 10,000**
- Country B: (500 + 500 + 500 + 500 + 48000) ÷ 5 = 50000 ÷ 5 = **Rs 10,000**

Both countries have the same average income.

2 **Will you be equally happy to live in both these countries? Are both equally developed?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Most people would prefer country A.

- In country A income is distributed fairly equally; no one is very rich or extremely poor.
- In country B four citizens are very poor and one is extremely rich.

So though the average income is the same, country A is better; the average does not show how income is distributed.

⭐ Let's Work These Out · How to Compare Different Countries or States?

1 **Give three examples where an average is used for comparing situations.**

✔ ANSWER

- Average marks of students of two classes or schools.
- Average (per capita) income of two countries or states.
- Average rainfall or temperature of two places; a batsman's batting average.

2 **Why do you think average income is an important criterion for development? Explain.**

✔ ANSWER

- Countries have different populations, so total income cannot be compared; average income shows what an average person earns.
- More income means people can buy more of the things they need.
- It is easy to measure and compare; the World Bank uses it to classify countries as rich or low-income.

3 **Besides size of per capita income, what other property of income is important in comparing two or more societies?**

✔ ANSWER

Distribution of income (equality): how income is shared among people. A society where income is equally distributed is better than one where a few are very rich and most are poor, even if the average is the same.

4 **Suppose records show that the average income in a country has been increasing over a period of time. From this, can we conclude that all sections of the economy have become better? Illustrate your answer with an example.**

✔ ANSWER

No. A rising average can hide inequality.

Example: in a country of 5 people, incomes are Rs 1000 each (average Rs 1000). Next year, four still earn Rs 1000 but one earns Rs 6000. Average rises to Rs 2000, yet four people are no better off.

So the average may rise only because the rich become richer.

5 **From the text, find out the per capita income level of about 10-15 low-income countries as per World Development Reports.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The text says that countries with per capita income of about **US$ 2,300 or less** (2024) are called low-income countries.

Low-income countries in World Bank reports include: Afghanistan, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Central African Republic, Chad, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ethiopia, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mozambique, Niger, Sierra Leone, Somalia and South Sudan.

Find their exact per capita incomes in the latest World Bank World Development Indicators (www.worldbank.org).

6 **Write a paragraph on your notion of what should India do, or achieve, to become a developed country.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

To become a developed country, India must raise the income of all its people, not just a few. Everyone should get regular work at fair wages. Every child should get good school education and every person good health care, so that infant mortality falls and life expectancy rises. Inequality between rich and poor, men and women, and villages and cities must be reduced. Roads, electricity, clean water and sanitation should reach every village. Women should be safe and free. At the same time India must protect its environment and use groundwater, forests and minerals carefully, so that development is sustainable for future generations.

⭐ Let's Work These Out · Public Facilities

1 **Look at data in Tables 1.3 and 1.4. Is Haryana ahead of Kerala in literacy rate etc., as it is in terms of per capita income?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Haryana has higher per capita income (Rs 3,25,759 vs Rs 2,81,001), but Kerala is ahead in other indicators:

Indicator	Haryana	Kerala
Infant mortality rate (per 1000)	28	6
Literacy rate (%)	82	94
Net attendance ratio (15–17 yrs)	73	94

2 **Think of other examples where collective provision of goods and services is cheaper than individual provision.**

✔ ANSWER

- Security guards for a whole colony instead of each house.
- Public transport (buses, metro) instead of everyone using own vehicle.
- Government schools and hospitals.
- Street lights, roads, water supply and drainage.
- Parks and libraries.

3 **Does availability of good health and educational facilities depend only on amount of money spent by the government on these facilities? What other factors could be relevant?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Money is needed, but other factors matter too:

- Honest and efficient working of the facilities (teachers and doctors present).
- Awareness and willingness of people to use them.
- Social factors, e.g. whether girls are sent to school.
- Easy reach: distance, roads, transport.
- Safety, especially for girls; participation of the local community.

4 **In a study, it was found that in Tamil Nadu, 90 per cent of the people living in rural areas used a ration shop, whereas in West Bengal only 35 per cent of rural people did so. Where would people be better off and why?**

✔ ANSWER

People in Tamil Nadu would be better off.

- Its Public Distribution System (ration shops) works well and reaches most rural people.
- They get food grains at low prices, so poor families get enough food.

- So their health and nutritional status is likely to be better.

Activity 2 · Table 1.5 Educational Achievement of Rural Population of Uttar Pradesh

(a) **The literacy rate for all age groups, including young and old, is _____ for rural males and _____ for rural females. However, it is not just that these many adults could not attend school but that there are _____ who are currently not in school.**

✔ ANSWER

76% for rural males and **54%** for rural females. ... there are **children (aged 10–14)** who are currently not in school.

(b) **It is clear from the table that _____ % of rural girls and _____% of rural boys are not attending school. Therefore, illiteracy among children in the age group 10-14 is as high as _____% for rural females and _____% for rural males.**

✔ ANSWER

18% of rural girls (100 − 82) and **15%** of rural boys (100 − 85) are not attending school.

Illiteracy among children aged 10–14 is **13%** for rural females (100 − 87) and **10%** for rural males (100 − 90).

(c) **This high level of illiteracy among _____ age group, even after more than 75 years of our independence, is most disturbing.**

✔ ANSWER

10–14 years age group.

🧪 Activity 3 · Body Mass Index

? **Each student finds his or her weight (kg) and height (m) and calculates BMI = weight ÷ (height)². Look at the BMI-for-Age tables (pages 90–91) and discuss the life situation, food and exercise habits of students, in general, without body shaming anyone.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Example: weight 45 kg, height 1.55 m → BMI = 45 ÷ (1.55 × 1.55) = 45 ÷ 2.40 ≈ **18.7**. Compare it with the BMI-for-Age table for your age and gender.

Discussion points:

- Underweight students may not get enough nutritious food (pulses, milk, fruits, vegetables), often because of low family income.

- Overweight may come from junk food, sugary drinks and too little exercise or play.
- Regular meals, balanced diet, mid-day meals and daily physical activity help keep BMI normal.
- Respect everyone; talk about habits, not about any person's body.

⭐ Human Development Report

? Do you think there are certain other aspects that should be considered in measuring human development?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes. For example:

- Equality: distribution of income, gender equality.
- Nutrition and sanitation (BMI, clean water, toilets).
- Quality of environment (clean air and water).
- Safety and security, freedom and human rights.
- Employment and job security.

⭐ Sustainability of Development · Example 1: Groundwater in India

(a) Why groundwater is overused?

✔ ANSWER

- Heavy use of tubewells for irrigation in agriculturally prosperous regions like Punjab and Western U.P.
- Rapidly growing cities and industries need more water.
- More water is taken out than is replenished by rain.
- Water is wasted; water-hungry crops (rice, sugarcane) are grown.

(b) Can there be development without overuse?

✔ ANSWER

Yes. Development can be sustainable if:

- we use groundwater only as much as rain replenishes;
- rainwater harvesting and check dams recharge groundwater;
- drip and sprinkler irrigation and less water-hungry crops are used;
- water is not wasted in homes and industry.

Sustainability of Development · Example 2: Exhaustion of Natural Resources

(a) **Table 1.7: crude oil reserves (2017) — Middle East 836 thousand million barrels (will last 70 years), USA 69 (10.5 years), World 1732 (47 years).**

Is crude oil essential for the development process in a country? Discuss.

✔ ANSWER

Yes, at present crude oil is essential.

- Petrol and diesel run transport: cars, buses, trucks, ships, planes.
- It is used in industries, farm machines and power generation.
- It is a raw material for plastics, fertilisers, chemicals, medicines.

But it is non-renewable and will last only about 50 more years, so countries must shift to renewable sources like solar, wind and hydro energy.

(b) **India has to import crude oil. What problems do you anticipate for the country looking at the above situation?**

✔ ANSWER

- India spends a lot of foreign exchange on oil imports.

- If oil prices rise, transport and goods become costly (inflation), a burden for everyone.
- Supply may be cut by wars or political problems in oil-producing regions.
- As world reserves run out, oil will become scarce and very expensive.

So India must save oil and develop alternative energy sources.

📝 Exercises

1 **Development of a country can generally be determined by**

(i) its per capita income

(ii) its average literacy level

(iii) health status of its people

(iv) all the above

✔ ANSWER

(iv) all the above – income, education and health together show development.

2 **Which of the following neighbouring countries has better performance in terms of human development than India?**

(i) Bangladesh

(ii) Sri Lanka

(iii) Nepal

(iv) Pakistan

✔ ANSWER

(ii) Sri Lanka – HDI rank 89 against India's 130; it is ahead in income, life expectancy and schooling.

3 **Assume there are four families in a country. The average per capita income of these families is Rs 5000. If the income of three families is Rs 4000, Rs 7000 and Rs 3000 respectively, what is the income of the fourth family?**

(i) Rs 7500

(ii) Rs 3000

(iii) Rs 2000

(iv) Rs 6000

✔ ANSWER

(iv) Rs 6000. Total = 5000 × 4 = 20000; 20000 − (4000 + 7000 + 3000) = 20000 − 14000 = 6000.

4 **What is the main criterion used by the World Bank in classifying different countries? What are the limitations of this criterion, if any?**

✔ ANSWER

Criterion: the World Bank uses **per capita (average) income**. In 2024, countries with per capita income of US$ 66,500 and above were high-income (rich) countries, and those with about US$ 2,300 or less were low-income countries.

Limitations:

- It hides inequality: it does not show how income is distributed among people.
- It ignores non-material things like freedom, equality, security and respect.
- It does not show health, education or nutrition (e.g. Haryana has higher income than Kerala but higher infant mortality and lower literacy).
- Money cannot buy everything, e.g. a pollution-free environment or public facilities.
- It does not show whether development is sustainable.

5 **In what respects is the criterion used by the UNDP for measuring development different from the one used by the World Bank?**

✔ ANSWER

World Bank	UNDP
Uses only per capita income	Uses the Human Development Index (HDI)
Based on one economic factor	Based on income, health and education
Classifies countries as rich, middle or low income	Ranks countries by HDI (out of 193)
Does not show quality of life	Uses life expectancy, mean years of schooling and per capita income, so it shows the well-being of people

UNDP's criterion is wider: it puts people, their health and well-being at the centre of development.

6 **Why do we use averages? Are there any limitations to their use? Illustrate with your own examples related to development.**

✔ ANSWER

Why: Totals cannot be compared when groups are of different size. An average (total ÷ number) gives one figure for comparing countries, states or groups, e.g. per capita income.

Limitations:

- Averages hide disparities; they do not show distribution.

- Extreme values (a few very rich people) can raise the average.

Example: In Table 1.2, country A (incomes about Rs 10,000 each) and country B (four earn Rs 500, one earns Rs 48,000) both have an average of Rs 10,000, but most people in B are poor.

Similarly, a state's average literacy may be high while literacy of rural girls is very low.

7 **Kerala, with lower per capita income has a better human development ranking than Haryana. Hence, per capita income is not a useful criterion at all and should not be used to compare states. Do you agree? Discuss.**

✔ ANSWER

No, I do not fully agree.

- Per capita income is still useful: more income helps people buy food, clothes and other needs, and it is easy to measure and compare.
- But it is **not an adequate** criterion alone. Kerala has a lower per capita income than Haryana, yet better infant mortality (6 vs 28), literacy (94% vs 82%) and school attendance (94 vs 73), because of good public health and education facilities.
- Income does not show distribution or non-material goals like health, education, freedom and equality.

Conclusion: per capita income should be used together with other indicators like health and education (as in HDI) to compare states.

8 **Find out the present sources of energy that are used by the people in India. What could be the other possibilities fifty years from now?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Present sources:

- Coal (thermal power), petrol, diesel, natural gas, LPG and kerosene.
- Hydro-electricity, nuclear power.
- Firewood, cow dung cakes and crop waste in villages.
- Growing use of solar and wind energy.

Fifty years from now:

- Since coal and oil are non-renewable and will get exhausted, much more solar, wind, tidal, geothermal and biogas energy.
- Electric vehicles; green hydrogen and other new fuels.
- More energy-efficient machines and homes.

9 **Why is the issue of sustainability important for development?**

✔ ANSWER

Sustainable development means meeting present needs without harming the ability of future generations to meet their needs.

- Present levels of development may not be sustainable: resources are being overused.
- Renewable resources like groundwater are overused (about 300 districts show a fall of over 4 m in 20 years).
- Non-renewable resources like crude oil will get exhausted (world reserves will last only about 50 years).
- Environmental degradation does not respect national or state boundaries; it affects everyone.
- We must keep development going for future generations: "We have not inherited the world from our forefathers — we have borrowed it from our children."

So development must be sustainable to last.

10 **"The Earth has enough resources to meet the needs of all but not enough to satisfy the greed of even one person". How is this statement relevant to the discussion of development? Discuss.**

✔ ANSWER

This statement (by Mahatma Gandhi) shows that resources are enough for everyone's **needs**, but greed leads to overuse and wastage.

- Greed of a few leads to overuse of groundwater, forests, minerals and oil.
- It leads to environmental degradation and pollution, which harms everyone.
- Resources get concentrated with a few, increasing inequality.
- Overuse leaves nothing for future generations, so development is not sustainable.

So for real development we must use resources wisely, share them fairly and avoid wastage.

11 **List a few examples of environmental degradation that you may have observed around you.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Cutting of trees and forests (deforestation).
- Air pollution from vehicles, factories and burning of crop stubble.
- Water pollution: sewage and waste in rivers and ponds.
- Falling groundwater levels.
- Heaps of plastic and garbage; soil erosion; noise pollution.

12 **For each of the items given in Table 1.6, find out which country is at the top and which is at the bottom.**

✔ ANSWER

Item	Top	Bottom
GNI per capita (2021 PPP $)	Sri Lanka (12,616)	Nepal (4,726)
Life expectancy at birth	Sri Lanka (77.5)	Myanmar (66.9)
Mean years of schooling (25+)	Sri Lanka (10.8)	Pakistan (4.3)
HDI rank in the world	Sri Lanka (89)	Pakistan (168)

13 (i) **Proportion of adults (15–49 years) with BMI below normal (2019–21):**

State	Male (%)	Female (%)
Kerala	8.5	10
Karnataka	17	21
Madhya Pradesh	28	28
All States	20	23

Compare the nutritional level of people in Kerala and Madhya Pradesh.

✔ ANSWER

- In Kerala only 8.5% men and 10% women are undernourished.

- In Madhya Pradesh 28% men and 28% women are undernourished – about three times Kerala's level.
- So people in Kerala are much better nourished; Madhya Pradesh is even worse than the all-India average (20% and 23%).

13 (ii) **Can you guess why around one-fifth of people in the country are undernourished even though it is argued that there is enough food in the country? Describe in your own words.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Poverty:** many people do not have enough income to buy nutritious food.
- The Public Distribution System (ration shops) does not work well in many states.
- Unequal distribution: food is stored in godowns but does not reach the poor.
- Lack of awareness about a balanced diet.
- Poor health facilities, unclean water and diseases.
- Women and girls often eat last and least in many families.

Additional Project / Activity

? **Invite three different speakers to talk to you about the development of your region. Ask**

them all the questions that come to your mind. Discuss these ideas in groups. Each group should prepare a wall chart, giving reasons about ideas that you agree or do not agree with.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model plan:

- **Speakers:** e.g. a farmer or panchayat member, a doctor or teacher, a local businessperson or social worker.
- **Questions:** What are the main problems of our area? What should be done for jobs, schools, hospitals, roads, water? Who gains and who loses from new projects? How can we protect the environment?
- **Group work:** list each speaker's ideas and discuss them.
- **Wall chart:** two columns – “Ideas we agree with” and “Ideas we do not agree with”, each with reasons; add pictures and a slogan.

🎉 **Chapter 1 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**